



ANAVRYTA MODEL LYCEUM MODEL UNITED NATIONS CONFERENCE



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SECURITY COUNCIL MANUAL

REVIEWED BY ADVISOR N.P. FOR THE 5TH AMLMUN SESSION



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SECRETARY GENERAL'S OPENING LETTER

SECURITY COUNCIL MANUAL

JURISDICTION

The Security Council (SC or UNSC) is one of the 5 main organs of the United Nations. It aims at resolving issues threatening international peace and security. Therefore, it deals not only with matters of security, but also with social and economic issues impacting international equality and stability. Its decisions are mandatory and all UN Member States are obligated to abide by them. In order to enforce these decisions, the UNSC Members have the right to decide on the deployment of peacekeeping operations and interventions as well as the imposition of sanctions on States and parties violating international law.

MEMBERS

The Security Council consists of 15 members, which are UN Member States, 5 permanent with veto power, also referred to as “the P5” (Permanent 5)—namely People’s Republic of China, France, the Russian Federation, the United Kingdom and the United States of America—and 10 non-permanent Member States. The latter are elected by the General Assembly for two year-terms based on geographical criteria, in order to ensure that views of all geographical regions are involved in decision making.

LOBBYING AND DEBATING

The SC lobbies in the same manner as the rest of the committees. Each alliance is to draft a resolution with a submitter for each operative clause. The submitter will be written at the end of each clause in this manner: **(Submitted by Germany)**.

The clauses from each alliance’s resolution will be debated upon after they have been checked by the approval panel. All members of the alliance will be submitters to the resolution and the main submitter is to be decided by them.

The debate in the Security Council is a clause-by-clause debate. More specifically, clauses are submitted, debated and voted separately, so that a common resolution of the Council including all the passed clauses will have been formed by the end of the session. It is advisable that clauses are clear and effective enough, while they are supposed to include a certain measure that is to be explained thoroughly, but is not to be accompanied by any kind of explanation of the motives for each clause. The clauses are introduced by the submitting Member State through a short introductory speech. In general, the typical Rules of Procedure concerning the debate mode apply to the Security Council as well. For instance, the debate mode for discussing clauses is an open debate; however, when debating amendments, the debate mode is a closed debate. Amendments of the first and second degree to a



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clause can only be entertained during the debate time on the relevant clause. Amendments seeking to insert new clauses are debated after all clauses have been debated upon, and only as long as time constraints allow it.

After all clauses and amendments have been debated separately, it is time for the House to debate and vote on the resolution as a whole as it is in its final form. Open debate mode is to be used.

VOTING AND VETO POWER

For a decision to be made, a minimum number of 9 votes in favor (or 2/3 majority if the delegates are less than 15) is needed. One of the special characteristics of the SC is the “veto power” of the P5-Members. When a P5 State votes against, this constitutes a veto and leads to the automatic rejection of the clause/amendment/resolution. When a delegate is to veto, they need to inform the Chairs beforehand by passing them a note stating they wish to veto, namely the “veto threat”. However, veto is rarely used. Thus, delegates must respect it.

Abuse of the veto power is a threat to the well-functioning of the council and as a result a warning can be issued. Vetoes need to be avoided as much as possible. Therefore, delegates are requested to try to amend anything that they do not agree with. In addition, in -case of a veto threat, there is the so-called “P5 caucus” between the P5 and one of the Presidents of the Council, which is a private talk that aims at finding a solution and preventing a veto. So, delegates are encouraged to avoid vetoing frequently and do so only if the policy of their country is strongly offended. This, however, does not mean that P5 nations are “forced” to agree with everything.

Should a P5 member want to vote against or at least not support a clause or amendment, then they are encouraged to abstain. Obviously, an abstention does not count as a veto, rather as non-participation in the voting procedure, and thus should be preferred. As stated, a veto is used only and if a country’s national benefits are critically threatened.

Note: Delegates of the Security Council are strongly advised to also study the Delegates Manual as the Security Council manual covers only the special rules of the Security Council and not the whole procedure of the committee’s session.